



What an exciting time it is to be involved with Rossholme – and our active supporters increase daily.

Anne Halliday, my cousin, who has been a long term supporter of Rossholme, reports on her first visit to Kenya:

THE TRIP OF A LIFE TIME

Back in June, my cousin, Mrs Judith Webb, and I went off to Kenya, on a two point trip. Needless to say one of those points was a safari, something that I'd wanted to do for a long time. It was a wonderful experience, to see all those animals in the wild, in their natural environment. It was unforgettable.

Even though that formed the largest part of the trip, it was not the main reason we went.

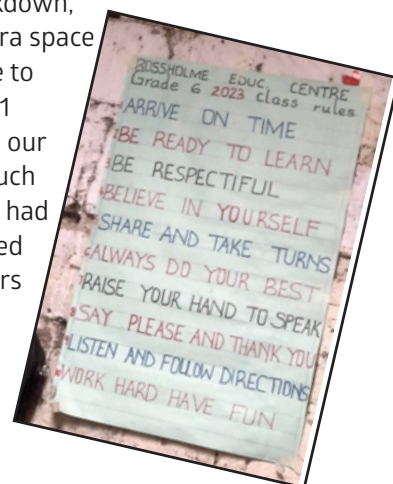
The main reason was to visit Rossholme Kenya in the Kiambiu Slum of Nairobi. What an experience! 425 children ranging in age from 3 – 12, all smiling and so happy in their learning experiences. Their days were long, from 7 in the morning till 5 in the evening, well 3:15 for the little ones. They were all immaculately dressed in their yellow and navy school uniforms, shoes clean and hair tidy. Their working environment was cramped but they were all so happy, eager to show us their school and what they were working at. In the afternoon, before we left, the different classes put on a wonderful impromptu concert, some singing, some reciting and some dancing, all so confident in what they were doing and their English was perfect. They were a joy to be with and a credit to their wonderful hard-working teachers.

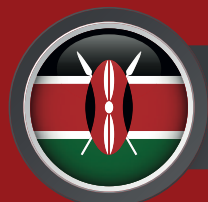
I just loved meeting them all. Thank you

Anne Halliday

Unfortunately, cheap flights and missed connections meant that we found ourselves in Addis Ababa, Ethiopia instead of Nairobi and so missed our first day's visit to the school but we made up for it the following day when an early car got us there by 7:30am. We were very warmly welcomed by Headteacher Joyce Aruga, her wonderful teaching staff, the cooks and the very cheerful pupils in their classrooms. These had been recently fitted out with solar panels to give lighting as well as purpose made locker desks, all thanks to the generous donations from East Africa Childrens Project (EACP), with whom we have established a very useful link.

This was my first visit to these premises which Joyce had managed to find at very short notice back in December 2019, just before Covid lockdown. They provided so much extra space meaning we were now able to accommodate 425 pupils, 11 teaching staff, 2 cooks and our valued security guard. A much more spacious central area had been resurfaced and enabled the children to play outdoors more easily, even if it was only one class at a time.





**ROSSHOLME
KENYA**

GOOD NEWS

Registered as a Charitable
Incorporated Organisation
(CIO), Charity No 1178553

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Charitable Incorporated
Organisation (CIO), Charity
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For further info please
contact Judy Webb
judy@rossholmeinkenya.org

FUNDRAISING

We are a registered charity
(number 1178553) which
means that Gift Aid can
be claimed on donations
made by UK tax payers.
Donations can now be made
through CAFDonate which
can be accessed through our
website:

www.rossholmeinkenya.org

CAFDonate will also
process the GiftAid or,
alternatively, if donations
are made directly to the
charity, a GiftAid form can
be downloaded from the
website and returned to:
judy@rossholmeinkenya.org
25% Gift Aid makes a
significant difference to
the donations you
are kind enough to
make. Unfortunately,
Amazon Smile have now
discontinued their donations
on every purchase made.

We aim to publish a
Newsletter about every
6 months so, if you know
of anyone else who may
be interested in receiving
one by email, please let us
know. In line with GDPR, we
need permission for names
to be on a mailing list but
we assure you that it is not
published anywhere; it is
retained only by us and all
emails are BCC'd so no list of
emails is available.

The good news from Joyce was that the
Landlord had decided to take retirement from
the slum and had offered Joyce first refusal
on the acquisition of the property and land
which we are currently renting. All slum land
in Kenya is Government owned so we would
not be able to 'purchase' the land as such but
it would certainly give us the best possible
option. All our children are slum residents
so this is where we need to be; acquisition of
this land and property, even on these limited
terms, would give us more security and enable
us to develop the school.

It was therefore, in July that we launched
a Project Campaign to raise KES4,500,000
(c.£25,000 at current exchange rates) by the
end of the year – quite an ambitious target
but we have made good progress thus far and
we are optimistic that our goal is achievable.

A letter was sent out to all our supporters
explaining the situation and this has already
resulted in some generous donations. A
Rossholme Concert was held in the Appley
Pavilion in Somerset on 30th September,
featuring our local Village Festival Choir and
other local performers as well as professional
solo pianist, Richard Lennox (performing
at a much-reduced special rate). Richard is
himself from Weston super Mare and has a
long association with the original Rossholme
School in Somerset.

We are particularly grateful to the many local
helpers and volunteers who helped us on the
night and who contributed so generously.
Facebook posts and other publicity combined
with very generous support from the East
Africa Childrens Project (EACP), have

enabled us to secure
£15,290 to date.

**Steve Swan, who
has been a great
supporter for
several years
has written and
published a book,
especially for us, called
Having a Larf. As Mike Parkinson writes:**
"Steve has managed to create an extremely
funny book from some very off-the-wall
sketches which had everyone in stitches at
the time (last year's Having a Larf Show for
Rossholme). The themes and delivery in
What's that About? (the second part of the
book) are very relevant to today's world".
It is available for a donation (min £10 please)
from me, Judy Webb (in person or by email/
post, adding £2.60:) judy@rossholme.co.uk



A ROUGH RAMBLE FOR ROSSHOLME

Last year Kitty Hollingsworth very kindly
raised £820 for us by walking 26 miles across
Dartmoor. With her nephew Christian, she's
doing it again this year on Saturday 11th
November. Donations
can be made through our
website, or by using this
QR code:

*Thank you so much Kitty
and Christian!*



**STOP PRESS: they've done it and, so far,
have raised a fantastic £1220**



The opening of the first Kirsty's Place,
a Day Care Centre within Kiambu for
children too young to attend Rossholme



CAF
Charities Aid Foundation

*Fleximedia • 01278 722577
is proud to support &
donate their time to design
the Rossholme in Kenya
Newsletter*